

Enter your name and, optionally, your organisation name to personalise your copy of Windows XP. Click 'Next'.

Enter the 25-character product key that came with your copy of Windows XP and click 'Next'.

You need to enter a computer name and administrator password in the next dialog. The computer name cannot contain spaces or special characters such as underscores and question marks. Although not compulsory, a password can be assigned. Click 'Next'.

In the 'Date and Time Settings' dialog box that pops up, set the date and time, as well as your time zone. Click 'Next'.

Next appears the 'Networking Settings' dialog box, where you can install network software that allows you to connect to other computers and networks, and to the Internet. Choose 'Typical Settings' to create network connections using *Client for Microsoft Networks*, *File and Printer Sharing*, and *TCP/IP Protocol* with automatic addressing.

Choose 'Custom' if you wish to manually configure the networking components. Keep 'TCP/IP', 'Client for Microsoft Networks' and 'File and Printer Sharing' selected. Then, highlight the 'TCP/IP' selection and press 'Properties'. In the 'General' tab, enter the



Set the Regional and Language Options

required information. You must specify the IP address of the computer, and if you don't know what the 'Subnet Mask' entry is, simply place your mouse pointer over the empty area in the 'Subnet Mask' box and click it. XP will automatically select the value it thinks is best for the IP address you provided.